QUALITY ASSURANCE POLICY & PROCEDURES HANDBOOK

[Company Name] — Internal Reference

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Section 1: Defect Reporting

§1.1 Defect submission. Defects must include the affected product or process, steps to reproduce where applicable, expected behavior, observed behavior, and relevant evidence.

§1.2 Defect severity. QA assigns severity based on customer impact, business impact, frequency, and ability to work around the problem. The person submitting the issue may suggest severity but does not independently determine the final classification.

§1.3 Duplicate defects. Reports that appear to describe an existing defect should be linked to the existing record rather than creating unnecessary duplicate investigations.

> **Human Agent Notes — Section 1:** Do not close a defect simply because a workaround exists unless the applicable QA process permits it.

Section 2: Testing & Validation

§2.1 Test requests. QA testing requests must identify the release, feature, process, or change that requires validation and the expected completion timeframe.

§2.2 Test evidence. Test results should record the test case, result, environment where relevant, and evidence needed for later review.

§2.3 Failed validation. A failed test must be documented with sufficient evidence for the responsible team to reproduce or investigate the failure.

> **Human Agent Notes — Section 2:** QA can document test results but cannot independently approve a release when another authorized approval is required.

Section 3: Quality Trends

§3.1 Recurring defects. Repeated defects should be grouped and analyzed for common causes when sufficient evidence exists.

§3.2 Quality metrics. Quality metrics must use defined measurement rules and a stated reporting period. Metrics should not be compared across periods without accounting for changes in definitions or scope.

§3.3 Corrective action. Significant recurring quality problems may require a corrective-action plan with an owner, expected completion date, and verification step.

> **Human Agent Notes — Section 3:** Do not treat a single customer complaint as proof of a systemic defect without supporting evidence.

Section 4: QA/Customer Support Disambiguation

§4.1 Immediate customer issue. Customer Support owns resolving an individual customer's immediate problem. QA investigates recurring defects, systematic failures, and quality trends.

§4.2 Escalating patterns. Customer Support should provide QA with relevant evidence when multiple customer cases appear to represent the same underlying issue.

> **Human Agent Notes — Section 4:** Ask: **“Are we resolving one customer's issue, or investigating a recurring/systemic quality problem?”**